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MyDesign Portfolio

Element A Initial Template

Element A: Presentation and Justification of the Problem

Problem Statement and Details (A1, A2, A5)

The primary stakeholders in this problem include the rabbits residing at the Piedmont Wildlife Center, the staff responsible for their care, local veterinarians who provide medical attention, animal welfare advocates, and the families or individuals interested in adopting these animals. The rabbits at the center experience direct effects from their housing conditions because inappropriate hutches create situations that lead to both mental distress and violent behavior which ultimately results in unsatisfactory health conditions (American Veterinary Medical Association, 2019). Staff at the center use animal welfare standards to create a workplace which enables positive animal behavior through their established research evidence and professional guidelines which show that rabbits need both interactive activities and safe spaces to rest (Journal of Applied Animal Welfare Science, 2021; Royal Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals, 2018). Veterinarians emphasize the need for proper housing to prevent health issues such as pododermatitis and behavioral disorders (US Department of Agriculture, 2017). Animal welfare advocates and local adopters are also invested in ensuring the rabbits are healthy, socialized, and ready for rehoming, concerns echoed in recent local newspaper coverage on shelter standards (The News & Observer, 2023).

The solution to this problem creates wider effects which impact secondary stakeholders who include both the local community and environmental protection groups. Improved rabbit housing reduces the risk of disease outbreaks and enhances the reputation of the Piedmont Wildlife Center through its connection to local community trust which leads to increased visitor numbers (Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, 2018). The development of an appropriate hutch design follows established animal husbandry standards while it serves as a demonstration of best practices in the industry.

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The problem requires a solution because it creates three effects: these three effects animal protection and organizational standing and community confidence. Rabbits experience chronic stress and aggression and health problems because they live in environments that do not fulfill their physical and psychological requirements which veterinary and animal welfare literature documents as proven facts (American Veterinary Medical Association, 2019; Journal of Applied Animal Welfare Science, 2021). When shelters provide insufficient facilities for animals the organization endangers both animal welfare and public trust because their practices will lose credibility which leads to decreased community support and funding and fewer adoptions (The News & Observer, 2023). Compliance with housing standards today involves both best practices and regulatory requirements because the whole system depends on these standards according to the US Department of Agriculture and Royal Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (2017) and (2018).

The effects of the situation reach beyond animal welfare operations to impact local communities and environmental organizations. The organization establishes its dedication to ethical animal care through proper housing which protects public health while reducing disease transmission risks and building community trust (Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, 2018). The Piedmont Wildlife Center can establish a new animal welfare standard through its hutch improvements because animal shelters function as regional models which will benefit other organizations (Journal of the American Association for Laboratory Animal Science, 2019). The solution to this problem needs to be implemented because it will provide immediate benefits to all parties involved.